

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 575

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend the West Tennessee Annual Conference of the African Methodist Episcopal Church on the occasion of its 151<sup>st</sup> Session.

WHEREAS, the churches of our nation have been an integral part of our history as a people and have had an unparalleled impact in forming and maintaining a stable and just society; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should recognize those venerable religious institutions that, through their unflagging capacity for love, dedication of spirit, and faith in God, strive to enrich the lives of people in their communities; and

WHEREAS, the West Tennessee Annual Conference of the African Methodist Episcopal (AME) Church convened its 151<sup>st</sup> Session in Memphis, from October 7-11, 2025; and

WHEREAS, the 2025 Session was hosted by St. James African Methodist Episcopal Church, located at 600 North Fourth Street in Memphis, where Reverend Dr. Walter R. Henry faithfully serves as pastor; and

WHEREAS, building upon the strong foundation of African Methodism, more than 300 ministers, clergy, and lay delegates from across West Tennessee participated in worship, business, and service that continued the AME Church's longstanding commitment to minister to the social, spiritual, and physical development of all people; and

WHEREAS, in commemoration of the 151<sup>st</sup> Session of the West Tennessee Annual Conference of the African Methodist Episcopal (AME) Church, we wish to specially recognize the Church's leadership, pastors, and laity for their exemplary service to their fellow Christians and to the good people of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize and commend the West Tennessee Annual Conference of the African Methodist Episcopal Church on the occasion of its 151<sup>st</sup> Session and extend to the Church's ministers, clergy, and lay delegates our best wishes for continued success and happiness in the years to come.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.